

Fairness and Unfairness

WORD LIST

amenable	deception	forbearance	objective	partiality
partisanship	preconceived	slander	subjective	tolerate

We have all heard preschoolers shout simply, "That's not fair!" But fairness is actually a range of complex and subtle concepts that have been the subject of much thought and discussion. The words in this lesson help you communicate about these timeless topics.

1. **amenable** (ə-měn'ə-bəl) *adjective* from Latin *a-*, "against" + *minari*, "to threaten"

Willing to consider; open to advice or suggestion

- Meena's parents were **amenable** to extending her curfew, as long as she had her cell phone and called to check in.

2. **deception** (dī-sēp'shən) *noun* from Latin *decipere*, "to deceive"

A trick; an attempt to make someone believe something that is not true

- When she didn't do her homework, the child resorted to **deception**, telling her teacher she felt sick and needed to see the nurse.

deceive *verb* Don't try to **deceive** me; I know you came home late!

deceptive *adjective* His **deceptive** actions revealed his true intentions.

3. **forbearance** (fôr-bâr'əns) *noun* from Old English *forberan*, "to put up with"

Patience; not reacting when annoyed or harmed

- The big dog showed gentle **forbearance** toward the bothersome new kittens.

forbear *verb* (past tense: **forbore**) The king decided to **forbear** punishing the thief, giving him a chance to reform instead.

4. **objective** (əb-jěk'tīv) from Latin *ob-*, "toward" + *iacere*, "to throw"

a. *adjective* Fair; impartial

- It is difficult to be **objective** when you are judging a contest that a family member is competing in.

b. *adjective* Realistic; actual

- Many prejudices disappear when faced with **objective** facts.

c. *noun* A goal or purpose

- Toni's **objective** was to save enough money to buy a piano.

objectivity *noun* **Objectivity** is essential to making fair decisions.

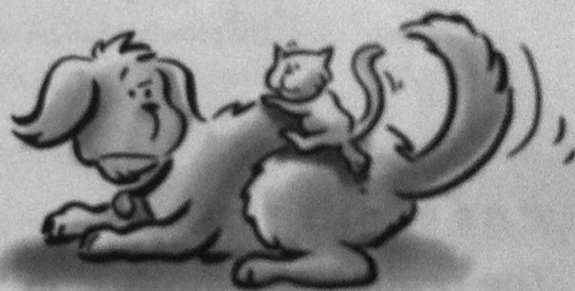
5. **partiality** (păr'shē-ăl'ī-tē) *noun* from Latin *parte*, "part"

A favorable bias or a prejudice toward something

- The competition judges' **partiality** to sopranos became clear when we noticed that all the finalists sang in that range.

partial *adjective* Costa's mother knew he was **partial** to chocolate cake.

We show *forbearance* to people and to situations that annoy or harm us.



a forbearing dog

6. **partisanship** (pär'tī-zənshĭp) *noun* from Latin *pars*, "part"
Very strong, sometimes excessive support for one group, idea, or cause
• Committee members showed their **partisanship** when they approved their party's nominee, despite his lack of qualifications.

partisan *adjective* Driven by **partisan** enthusiasm, Terry placed twenty "Vote for Smith" bumper stickers on her car.

Nonpartisan means "objective," or "not taking sides" with any group.

7. **preconceived** (prē'kən-sēvd) *adjective* from Latin *pre-*, "before" + *concipere*, "to take hold of"

Believed before one has full knowledge or experience

- Sean had a **preconceived** idea that he would hate summer camp.

preconception *noun* Any **preconceptions** we had that short people had trouble with basketball vanished when we saw Gabrielle on the court.

8. **slander** (slăn'där) from Latin *scaudalum*, "a cause of offense or sin"

a. *noun* False and harmful statements about someone

- The man was accused of **slander** because he called his political rival a thief.

b. *verb* To make false and harmful statements about someone

- The columnist was sued after she **slandered** her competitor on a talk show.

Subjective is the opposite of *objective*.

9. **subjective** (səb-jĕk'tĭv) *adjective* from Latin *sub-*, "under" + *iacere*, "to throw"

Governed by personal thoughts or feelings

- Judgments about art are often **subjective**.

subjectivity *noun* The coach appeared to show **subjectivity** when he picked his favorite student to be team captain.

10. **tolerate** (töl'ə-rāt) *verb* from Latin *tolerare*, "to bear"

To allow; to bear; to endure

- The understanding neighbors tried to **tolerate** the noise from the children who lived upstairs.

tolerance *noun* She showed great **tolerance** for differing viewpoints.

toleration *noun* The principal had no **toleration** for students who ran in the halls.

WORD ENRICHMENT

The prefix meaning "before"

The *pre-* in *preconceived* means "before." We are still using this prefix to form words. Newer ones include *prepay*, *preadolescent*, *pre-op* (before an operation), and *pregame*. Even the word *prefix* contains *pre-*; the word means "fixed before."

WRITE THE CORRECT WORD

Write the correct word in the space next to each definition.

- | | |
|---|---|
| _____ 1. fair; not influenced by emotions | _____ 6. a trick |
| _____ 2. excessive support for a cause or candidate | _____ 7. to tell harmful lies about someone |
| _____ 3. a preference for something | _____ 8. based on personal feelings |
| _____ 4. willing to consider something | _____ 9. formed without complete knowledge |
| _____ 5. to put up with | _____ 10. patience |

COMPLETE THE SENTENCE

Write the letter for the word that best completes each sentence.

- _____ 1. The TV ads _____ the politician's opponent with false charges of tax evasion.
a. tolerated b. forebore c. preconceived d. slandered
- _____ 2. It's not always easy to _____ the rude behavior of others.
a. slander b. tolerate c. deceive d. preconceive
- _____ 3. Sheila always seems _____ to helping her brother take out the garbage.
a. deceptive b. objective c. amenable d. partisan
- _____ 4. The crowd in the end zone displayed their _____ by wearing their school colors.
a. deception b. slander c. partisanship d. tolerance
- _____ 5. Mike displays admirable _____ toward his little brother's annoying behavior.
a. forbearance b. subjectivity c. partisanship d. objective
- _____ 6. The audience showed their _____ for the contestant by giving him loud applause.
a. partiality b. slander c. deception d. tolerance
- _____ 7. The _____ of the award was to honor the long service of the town's mayor.
a. deception b. forbearance c. subjective d. objective
- _____ 8. In an act of _____, the man fooled people into believing he was a physician.
a. subjectivity b. deception c. partisanship d. forbearance
- _____ 9. For many people, _____ ideas can be difficult to change.
a. tolerant b. preconceived c. amenable d. objective
- _____ 10. The critic's negative movie review was very _____; he clearly just doesn't like science fiction.
a. subjective b. partial c. amenable d. objective

Challenge: The clever political candidate used _____ to make his criticisms of his opponent appear to be _____.

- _____ a. deception...objective b. slander...preconceived c. partiality...slander

READING COMPREHENSION

The Bitter Campaign of 1800

Critics complain about today's "negative campaigning." But today's elections can't compare to the presidential election of 1800, in which President John Adams ran against his own vice president, Thomas Jefferson. The bitter campaign resulted in a crisis that ultimately changed the Constitution.

Once fast friends, Jefferson and Adams had become icy antagonists. They were members of opposing political parties: Adams was a Federalist, and Jefferson was a Republican. The campaign reflected the bitterness between the two parties. (1) *Slanders* came from everywhere. (2) Federalists believed in a strong federal government and had *preconceived* notions of Jefferson as a revolutionary, because he admired the recent French Revolution. They warned that he would unleash terror in the United States. One Federalist critic stated that, if Jefferson won, "the soil will be soaked with blood, and the nation black with crime." (3) This was hardly an *objective* assessment of the distinguished vice president.

(4) Republicans were also *partisan*. They accused Adams of trying to marry his daughter to the son of King George III, of England. (5) This charge was an attempt to *deceive* people into believing that Adams wanted to be king of the United States. Even Adams's own party proved disloyal. (6) A highly *subjective* and very critical letter by fellow Federalist Alexander Hamilton was leaked to the press.

According to the Constitution, candidates running for president and vice president were to be listed on the same ballot with no distinction between them. Members of the Electoral College were instructed to choose two names. The candidate who received the most votes would become president; the candidate with the second most votes would become vice president. When the election

results were tallied, Jefferson and his vice-presidential running mate, Aaron Burr, had each won the same number of votes, resulting in a tie for president. Burr refused to step aside—he wanted to be president, too. It was then up to members of the House of Representatives to choose between them. (7) Though the Federalists did not like Burr, they were unable to even *tolerate* the thought of Jefferson as president. So the Federalists voted for Burr, and the Republicans voted for Jefferson. The House voted thirty-five times, but the tie remained.



John Adams



Thomas Jefferson

(8) Finally, powerful Alexander Hamilton, who felt some *partiality* toward Jefferson and did not trust Burr, decided to encourage his party to support Jefferson. (9) A few Federalists from Delaware, wanting an end to the matter, proved *amenable* to Hamilton's influence. They agreed to hand in blank ballots rather than vote for Burr. On the thirty-sixth ballot, just fifteen days before inauguration day, Jefferson was elected president.

(10) Unable to demonstrate *forbearance* in the face of defeat, Adams left Washington, D.C., before dawn on inauguration day. Although Jefferson and Adams eventually reconciled, Burr and Hamilton became bitter enemies. In 1804, Burr killed Hamilton in a duel.

The most important legacy of the election of 1800 was the creation of the Twelfth Amendment to the Constitution. It states that electors must vote for the president and the vice president separately.

Each sentence below refers to a numbered sentence in the passage. Write the letter of the choice that gives the sentence a meaning that is closest to the original sentence.

- _____ 1. _____ came from everywhere.
 - a. Patience
 - b. Tricks
 - c. False statements
 - d. Fair judgments
- _____ 2. Federalists had _____ notions of Jefferson as a revolutionary.
 - a. accepted without question
 - b. emotional
 - c. willing
 - d. formed without knowledge
- _____ 3. This was hardly a _____ assessment of the distinguished vice president.
 - a. favorable
 - b. fair
 - c. popular
 - d. harmful
- _____ 4. Republicans were also _____.
 - a. willing to trick
 - b. weak in support
 - c. strong in support
 - d. eager to be fair

- _____ 5. This charge was an attempt to _____ people.
a. trick b. threaten c. consider d. frighten
- _____ 6. A highly _____ and very critical letter was leaked to the press.
a. detailed b. understanding c. agreeable d. personal
- _____ 7. The Federalists were unable to even _____ the thought of Jefferson as president.
a. forget b. endure c. favor d. remember
- _____ 8. Alexander Hamilton felt some _____ toward Jefferson.
a. friendship b. patience c. bias d. dislike
- _____ 9. A few Federalists from Delaware proved _____ to Hamilton's influence.
a. open b. opposed c. hostile d. resistant
- _____ 10. Unable to demonstrate _____ in the face of defeat, Adams left Washington, D.C., before dawn on inauguration day.
a. a trick b. certainty c. gratitude d. patience

Indicate whether the statements below are TRUE or FALSE according to the passage.

- _____ 1. Adams and Jefferson were close friends during the election campaign of 1800.
- _____ 2. Jefferson and Burr were members of the same political party.
- _____ 3. As a result of the election of 1800, a constitutional amendment changed the way electors vote in presidential elections.

WRITING EXTENDED RESPONSES

The presidential campaign of 1800 contained several elements of unfairness. We have all witnessed, or at least heard about, other situations or events that seem unfair or unjust. Write an expository essay at least three paragraphs long, detailing an event or a response that seems unfair to you. You may choose an example from your own life, or the life of a friend or family member. Or you may want to choose an example that you have seen or read about in the news. Describe the situation; remember to include reasons why it is unfair. Use at least three lesson words in your essay and underline them.

WRITE THE DERIVATIVE

Complete the sentence by writing the correct form of the word shown in parentheses. You may not need to change the form that is given.

- _____ 1. The store owner used false advertising to _____ potential customers.
(deception)
- _____ 2. Citing a series of harmful lies, Congressman Walkowitz accused his opponent of _____ him. (slander)

- _____ 3. A judge must make decisions with _____. (*objective*)
- _____ 4. The students were _____ to the new teacher, who assigned very little homework. (*partiality*)
- _____ 5. At times, unfair behavior by others may test your _____. (*tolerate*)
- _____ 6. Amelie was _____ to the idea of having the meeting at her house. (*amenable*)
- _____ 7. Do you think that _____ politics is a part of all democratic systems? (*partisanship*)
- _____ 8. The young babysitter's _____ that babies are easy to take care of was shattered when he took care of the one-year old. (*preconceived*)
- _____ 9. The salesclerk showed great _____ toward the rude customer. (*forbearance*)
- _____ 10. Arguments about which type of music is "best" are pointless because musical tastes involve _____. (*subjective*)

FIND THE EXAMPLE

Choose the answer that best describes the action or situation.

- _____ 1. Something difficult for some people to *tolerate*
a. criticism b. prizes c. sleep d. awards
- _____ 2. Something most people would be *amenable* to receiving
a. a fine b. threats c. money d. a punishment
- _____ 3. Something that young children are often *partial* to
a. asparagus b. sweets c. homework d. sweeping
- _____ 4. Something that is known for bringing out *partisan* behavior
a. an election b. a disaster c. a jail sentence d. a birthday party
- _____ 5. Something that is NOT a common *objective*
a. to get promoted b. to lose money c. to pass a test d. to win a game
- _____ 6. Socially acceptable *deceptions*
a. tax returns b. insensitive jokes c. magic tricks d. vicious lies
- _____ 7. Another word for a *preconceived* idea
a. a prefix b. a predicament c. a prejudice d. a pretest
- _____ 8. Something *subjective*
a. strength b. weight c. height d. attractiveness
- _____ 9. An example of *slander*
a. apologetic note b. overdue bill c. high praise d. false accusation
- _____ 10. A situation requiring *forbearance*
a. sound sleep b. rude interruption c. warm handshake d. well-balanced meal